His signature element was to add a large chinar tree somewhere within his compositions, to add drama, perspective, or symbology.

The de luxe manuscripts created in Lahore were tiny, meant to be held in the hand and admired closely. They contained only a dozen or so perfect works of art as opposed to the hundreds of paintings in earlier manuscripts. The texts were works of beloved poets such as Amir Khusro, Nizami, and Jami. Unlike the earlier exuberant and rambunctious works meant to be shared and exclaimed over, these small works were intimate, almost meditative, meant for the intense and visceral enjoyment of the patron, usually the Padshah, and his close family. One of the finest examples of de luxe manuscripts is the *Divan-e-Anvari*, a tiny work measuring only 5.5 inches by 2.8 inches, with just fifteen images. Anvari was a twelfth-century poet from Turkmenistan, who is believed to have suffered from gout, leading to understandably caustic and sharp reams such as the following qit'a*:

> I asked for wine, and you gave me stale vinegar,
> Such that, should I drink it, I should rise up at the Resurrection like pickled meat…

Art historian Kavita Singh points out that these de luxe manuscripts, like Anvari's *Divan*, indulged in 'conspicuous luxury' in all aspects of their making, 'from the fine, gold-flecked paper and costly pigments used for the books to the superb calligraphy by master calligraphers, and the exquisite margins, elaborate illumination, and fine bindings with which they were decorated'. Historian Annemarie Schimmel adds the awe-inspiring detail that each figure in the paintings was 'scarcely larger than an eyelash', yet managed to convey, possibly for the first time in Mughal art, a sense of a breathing space around the people, animals, and landscape. It is believed that a reason for the dramatic change in style from the earlier large-scale and boisterous works was the presence at court of Prince Salim, nineteen years old at the time, and as yet not estranged from his father. Salim who had begun drinking wine in increasingly immoderate quantities. Soon he was drinking twenty cups a day, lacking the iron will and self-discipline of his father. But despite his dissolute ways, Salim would go on to become a legendary patron and connoisseur of art who claimed to be able to distinguish at a single glance the distinctive brushwork of different painters. He even wrote with no false modesty whatsoever that in a work involving